Deliverable 1 — Strategic University Shortlist & Financial Model

Prepared 15 October 2026 for Bhumika V S · Planning FX rate ₹110 / €1 (stress-test rate, not a live quote) · All 2027/28 fees must be re-confirmed on the official university page before any deposit or loan application.

> **Bottom line.** Apply to four specialist programmes, not to "International Business". The best funding fit is **University of Limerick (MSc Insurance & Risk Management)**. The best academic and career fit is **University of Galway (MSc International Accounting & Analytics, Pathway A)**. Galway works at the loan ceiling plus savings, with part-time income or any scholarship covering the remaining gap of roughly €5–7k. **DCU** is a strong programme, but Dublin rent leaves a gap of about €14k. **Trinity** is affordable only with GOI-IES or another large award.

1. Why this shortlist (and why not the IDP list)

The IDP shortlist dated 17 Sept 2026 lists 17 UK *International Business / Management* MSc programmes. Every one is rejected for three reasons:

1. **Duplication of the MBA.** A second broad management degree adds little academic value. It is also the weakest story for a visa officer, who will ask why an MBA holder with 3.5 years of experience is repeating general management. A specialist degree gives a clean answer.
2. **Weaker post-study route.** UK Graduate Route applications made on or after 1 January 2027 give 18 months, not 2 years. Ireland gives Level 9 graduates up to 24 months on Stamp 1G.
3. **Price.** Most of the IDP programmes cost £18,000–£32,000 before London or UK living costs, and none of them builds on her tax or compliance experience.

The anchor narrative used across every document:

Existing asset	Becomes	Target programme
B.Com (8.43 CGPA) + EY Global Mobility Tax	International accounting, reporting, audit and analytics	Galway MSc IAA · DCU MSc IAB
Amazon GSRC compliance audits, RCA, CAPA	Operational risk, regulatory compliance, financial regulation	UL MSc Insurance & Risk Management
MBA (general management)	The management base. The new master's adds technical depth on top of it and does not repeat it	All

2. The four-programme portfolio at a glance

Bucket	Programme	Tuition (latest published)	₹ at ₹110	Living (12 months)	Fit
Core 1 — Top fit	University of Galway — MSc International Accounting & Analytics (Pathway A), 90 ECTS	**€20,890** (2026/27)	₹22.98 L	€15,000–€19,000	★★★★★
Core 2 — Top fit / most affordable	University of Limerick — MSc Insurance & Risk Management (previously listed as *Risk Management & Insurance*)	**≈€18,400** (latest published; 2027/28 not yet confirmed)	₹20.24 L	€13,000–€18,000	★★★★☆
Core 3 — Urban bridge	Dublin City University — MSc International Accounting & Business (DC526)	**€23,000** (−€2,000 if the DCU award is granted)	₹25.30 L (₹23.10 L net)	€21,050–€27,050	★★★★☆

Bucket	Programme	Tuition (latest published)	₹ at ₹110	Living (12 months)	Fit
Pivot / Reach	Trinity College Dublin — MSc Operations & Supply Chain Management *(or DCU MSc Management — Operations & Supply Chain, €23,000)*	**€24,600** (2027/28) + student levies	₹27.06 L	€21,050–€27,050	★★★☆☆

Fee discipline. Irish universities usually raise non-EU fees by 2–5% each year. For every programme where only a 2026/27 figure is published, budget a **+4% contingency** (Galway ≈ €21,725; UL ≈ €19,135). Do not put a scholarship into the base plan until it is awarded in writing.

3. Programme-by-programme dossiers

Core 1 — University of Galway · MSc International Accounting & Analytics (Pathway A)

Item	Detail
School	J.E. Cairnes School of Business & Economics
Structure	90 ECTS over 12 months: two teaching semesters, then two mandatory professional summer schools (May to June/July)
Core modules (recent handbooks)	Advanced International Financial Reporting & Analysis (AY5122) · Auditing & Assurance II (AY5120) · Advanced Corporate Finance (AY5109) · Accounting & Management Control for Sustainable Organisations (AY5141) · Data Science & Big Data Analytics (MS5106) · Analytical & Communication Skills Development (AY5121)
Electives	Sustainable Accounting, Finance & Governance (AY5142) · analytics electives · **AI for Business (MS5137, new elective from 2026/27)**
Tuition	€20,890 (2026/27 non-EU) → **₹22.98 L**; with 4% contingency ≈ €21,725 → ₹23.90 L
Living cost (Galway)	€15,000–€19,000 per year → ₹16.5–20.9 L. A shared room in Galway city typically costs €650–€900 a month. University residences (Corrib Village, Goldcrest) are cheaper but limited.
Entry prerequisites	(1) A Level 8 business/commerce degree at **2.1 equivalent**. Galway's India guidance uses percentages: about **65% = 2.1** and **75% = First** (thresholds are slightly lower for top-100 NIRF institutions). Her B.Com transcript shows about **85%**, which is comfortably above the First-equivalent line, subject to Galway's own assessment. (2) **Intermediate-level study of Financial Accounting, Management Accounting and Business Finance.** Her B.Com covers all three. *Action: highlight these papers on the transcript and attach the Bangalore University syllabus.*
English	IELTS Academic 6.5 overall, no band below 6.0. **Target 7.0** for safety and scholarship competitiveness. TOEFL/PTE/Duolingo equivalents may be accepted; check the portal.
GRE / GMAT	Not required
Scholarships	The Cairnes **Business Postgraduate Merit Scholarships for 2027/28 are under review**. The school has said earlier values and deadlines do not apply. Watch the page from November and apply on the day it opens. Also apply for GOI-IES (see §6).
Application fee tactic	Apply through the Galway postgraduate portal (opens 1 October for the following September). Ask Galway's India team, through the *Education in Ireland* fair or Galway's India representatives, whether a fee waiver code is available. Waivers are discretionary and not guaranteed.
Deadline reality	Rolling admissions for non-EU applicants, and popular programmes fill early. **Submit by 30 November 2026.**
Professional recognition	Graduates typically gain exemptions toward ACCA / CAI / CPA Ireland. Confirm the current exemption grid on the programme page.

Item	Detail
Post-study alignment	Big 4 offices in Galway and Dublin (audit, tax and risk advisory), shared-service finance centres in the West of Ireland, and MedTech multinationals with heavy regulatory reporting. Typical first roles: **Tax Analyst €45–55k**, **Financial / Regulatory Reporting Analyst**, **Risk Analyst €40–60k** (Morgan McKinley Dublin 2026 guide; regional pay is roughly 5–15% lower).

Why it is #1: It is the only programme on the list that directly compounds all three of her assets: B.Com accounting, EY tax, and Amazon data-quality work feeding into analytics. Its prerequisite check also *favours* a commerce graduate over a career-changer.

Core 2 — University of Limerick · MSc Insurance & Risk Management

Item	Detail
School	Kemmy Business School
Structure	One year full-time, streamlined over three semesters (Autumn, Spring, Summer)
Modules (recent listings)	*Autumn:* Corporate Sustainability · Underwriting Risk · Global Finance · Risk Modelling & Derivative Markets. *Spring:* **Financial Regulation** · Insuring Life & Health Risks · **Data Science for Risk Management** · Climate Risk Resilience. *Summer:* Research Dissertation **or** Digital Futures Lab + Business Analytics Simulation
Tuition	**≈€18,400** (latest published non-EU) → **₹20.24 L**; with 4% contingency ≈ €19,135 → ₹21.05 L. *The official 2027/28 fee has not been published yet. Email the Kemmy Business School international office before borrowing.*
Living cost (Limerick)	€13,000–€18,000 per year → ₹14.3–19.8 L. UL Studentpad rooms run about €580–€970 a month including utilities.
Entry prerequisites	Level 8 degree, minimum **2.2** honours, in a relevant discipline (business, finance, economics, mathematics). Her B.Com clears this comfortably. UL also operates **Recognition of Prior Learning**, which helps an applicant with 3.5+ years of experience.
English	IELTS Academic 6.5 overall, no band below 6.0. Target 7.0.
GRE / GMAT	Not required
Professional recognition	Recognised by the **Insurance Institute of Ireland (III)** and the **Chartered Insurance Institute (CII)**, giving partial exemption toward post-Master's professional qualifications (historically up to 60 Advanced Diploma credits under CII rules). This is a real credential advantage for risk roles in Ireland and the UK.
Scholarships	UL International has historically offered partial merit fee reductions for non-EU postgraduates. **The 2027/28 terms are not yet published**, so check UL Global/International in November 2026. Also apply for GOI-IES.
Application fee tactic	UL's India representatives attend *Education in Ireland* fairs. Ask in person for a waiver code.
Post-study alignment	Ireland is a European hub for insurance and reinsurance and for aircraft leasing risk, with large employers in Dublin and Limerick/Shannon. Fits **Risk Analyst**, **Operational Risk**, **Compliance Analyst (€35–48k)**, **Regulatory Reporting**, and **Underwriting/Claims analytics** roles. Amazon GSRC root-cause and CAPA work translates directly into operational-risk language.

Why it is Core 2 and not #1: It is the safest financially, but it moves her into insurance, a narrower sector than accounting. It is the best choice if she wants to build on Amazon compliance rather than EY tax. If the 2027/28 fee stays near €18.4k, it is the **financial anchor** of the portfolio.

Core 3 — Dublin City University · MSc International Accounting & Business (DC526)

Item	Detail
School	DCU Business School (Triple-accredited: AACSB, EQUIS, AMBA)
Structure	One year full-time

Item	Detail
Modules (DCU registration schedule)	*Year-long:* Financial Management · **Data Analytics for Accounting & Business** · Building Sustainable Organisations · Career Development. *Sem 1:* International Financial Accounting Principles · Management Accounting: Costing, Planning & Control. *Sem 2:* International Financial Reporting · Management Accounting: Decision-making & Performance. *Option:* Project Management or Research Methods. *Capstone:* Applied Business Project or Applied Research Project
Tuition	**€23,000** → ₹25.30 L. With the €2,000 DCU Business School award: **€21,000 → ₹23.10 L**
Living cost (Dublin)	€21,050–€27,050 per year (Trinity's published postgraduate estimate) → ₹23.2–29.8 L
Entry prerequisites	2.1 honours degree in **any** discipline. A 2.2 may be considered depending on places.
English	IELTS 6.5 overall, minimum 6.0 per band (confirm on the DCU page)
GRE / GMAT	Not required
Important caveat	DCU markets DC526 as a **conversion programme for non-business graduates**. For a B.Com holder, Semester 1 content will partly repeat material she already knows. The real value-add is the Dublin employer network, the triple-crown school brand, and professional exemptions: **ACCA (six F-level papers)** and **Chartered Accountants Ireland CAP 1 (three subjects, each needing ≥50%)**. Frame it in the SOP as *"a fast route to ACCA/CAI-recognised credentials and a Dublin Big 4 network,"* not as new technical depth.
Scholarships	**DCU 2027/28 International Scholarship for Non-EU Students: €2,000 fee reduction for successful applicants to DC526 (and DC537 MSc Management), assessed automatically. No separate form is needed**, but early applicants are considered while funds remain.
Application fee tactic	DCU runs frequent India webinars and fair stands, which is the best place to request a waiver code.
Post-study alignment	Strongest access to Dublin Big 4 graduate intakes (Deloitte, EY, KPMG, PwC, Grant Thornton, BDO, Mazars/Forvis), the IFSC, and Tech EMEA HQs (Google, Meta, Amazon, Stripe, TikTok), which hire for trust & safety, platform compliance and tax.

Why Core 3: The academic and career fit is excellent, but the **Dublin living cost is the binding constraint**. Keep it in the portfolio because a Dublin offer combined with a GOI-IES award, or cheaper shared housing in North Dublin, changes the maths.

Pivot / Reach — Trinity College Dublin · MSc Operations & Supply Chain Management

Item	Detail
School	Trinity Business School (Triple-accredited), cohort of about 40
Tuition	**€24,600 (2027/28, published)** + student levies → ₹27.06 L, **above the ₹25 L tuition ceiling on its own**
Living cost	€21,050–€27,050 (Trinity's own estimate)
Entry	2.1 or international equivalent (Trinity's own assessment). IELTS 6.5, no band below 6.0.
Scholarships	The Trinity **Global Excellence Postgraduate Scholarship excluded Business in 2026/27**. Do not assume it for 2027/28. TBS-specific awards are limited.
Fit	Strong for her Amazon platform-operations story, but a **larger pivot** away from tax and compliance
Cheaper alternative in the same lane	**DCU MSc Management (Operations & Supply Chain), DC537 — €23,000**, also eligible for the DCU €2,000 award

Rule: Apply to Trinity only if (a) family support of roughly ₹15–20 L above the loan is confirmed, or (b) GOI-IES is awarded. It is a prestige reach, not a plan.

4. Financial model — stress-tested at ₹110 / €

4.1 Funding available (assumption, to be confirmed by Bhumika)

Source	€	₹
Education loan (absolute ceiling)	27,273	30.0 L
Personal savings / family (assumed mid-point of ₹5–8 L)	5,909	6.5 L
Total committed funds	**33,182**	**36.5 L**
Part-time work (buffer only, **not** base plan): 15 hrs/week × €14.15 × 36 working weeks	≈7,640 gross	≈8.4 L

4.2 Cost of attendance (12 months)

One-off costs are estimated at **€2,500 (₹2.75 L)**: flight ≈€600, visa fee €60 plus VFS service fee, IRP registration €300, private medical insurance €200–€550, accommodation deposit and setup ≈€1,000, plus books and laptop contingency.

Programme	Tuition	Living (low – high)	One-off	**Total (low – high)**	**₹ (low – high)**
Galway — IAA	€20,890	€15,000 – €19,000	€2,500	**€38,390 – €42,390**	**₹42.2 – 46.6 L**
UL — Insurance & Risk Mgmt	€18,400	€13,000 – €18,000	€2,500	**€33,900 – €38,900**	**₹37.3 – 42.8 L**
DCU — IAB (with €2k award)	€21,000	€21,050 – €27,050	€2,500	**€44,550 – €50,550**	**₹49.0 – 55.6 L**
DCU — IAB (no award)	€23,000	€21,050 – €27,050	€2,500	**€46,550 – €52,550**	**₹51.2 – 57.8 L**
Trinity — OSCM	€24,600 + levies	€21,050 – €27,050	€2,500	**€48,150 – €54,150+**	**₹53.0 – 59.6 L+**

4.3 Funding gap (mid-point living cost) against ₹36.5 L committed funds

Programme	Mid-point total	Gap after committed funds	Can part-time (≈€7.6k gross) close it?	Verdict
UL	€36,400 (₹40.0 L)	**€3,218 (₹3.5 L)**	Yes, comfortably	✅ **Solvent**
Galway	€40,390 (₹44.4 L)	**€7,208 (₹7.9 L)**	Just. It works only if a job is secured by November, so a €2–5k scholarship or ₹3–4 L extra family support is strongly preferred	🟡 **Viable with buffer**
DCU (award)	€47,550 (₹52.3 L)	**€14,368 (₹15.8 L)**	No	🔴 Needs extra ₹8–10 L or GOI-IES
Trinity	€51,150+ (₹56.3 L+)	**€17,968+ (₹19.8 L+)**	No	🔴 Reach only

> **Decision rule:** If both Galway and UL make offers, choose **Galway** if any Galway scholarship is awarded or extra family support of at least ₹4 L is confirmed. Otherwise choose **UL**. Accept a Dublin offer only with GOI-IES or written proof of another ₹10 L+.

4.4 Immigration proof of funds (the visa view, not the real budget)

For a one-year course, Irish Immigration Service Delivery (ISD) expects:

- **At least €6,000 of tuition already paid** to the university, or the full fee if it is under €6,000. Most students pay the full first-year fee before applying, which strengthens the application.

- **Immediate access to at least €10,000 for living expenses**, plus evidence that any unpaid balance of fees is covered.

Programme	Fees + €10,000	₹
Galway	€30,890	₹33.98 L
UL	€28,400	₹31.24 L
DCU (award)	€31,000	₹34.10 L

The loan (₹30 L) plus savings (₹6.5 L) covers the **visa threshold** for every Core programme. The visa threshold is a minimum and is **not** the real cost of living (see §4.2).

4.5 Loan repayment model (illustrative: 12% p.a., monthly EMI)

Loan	Balance at repayment start	24-month EMI	36-month EMI	60-month EMI
₹25 L, interest paid during study	₹25.0 L	₹1.18 L	₹0.83 L	₹0.56 L
₹25 L, 12 months' interest capitalised	≈₹28.2 L	₹1.33 L	₹0.94 L	₹0.63 L
₹30 L, interest paid during study	₹30.0 L	₹1.41 L	₹1.00 L	₹0.67 L
₹30 L, 12 months' interest capitalised	≈₹33.8 L	₹1.59 L	₹1.12 L	₹0.75 L

Post-study cash-flow check (Galway or Limerick, single person, 2026 Irish tax rules, approximate): A €45,000 salary nets about **€37,000 a year (≈€3,080 a month)** after income tax, USC and PRSI. With a regional single-room budget of about €1,500 a month all-in, the monthly surplus is roughly **€1,500 (≈₹1.65 L)**. That supports a **36-month base-case repayment** with prepayments, and a 24-month payoff only in the upside case. **Plan on 36–60 months and prepay when possible.** Do not build the decision on a 20-month payoff.

Loan tactics: * Get **written** sanction offers from at least three lenders: one public bank (SBI Global Ed-Vantage, which usually needs collateral above ₹7.5 L) and two NBFCs (for example Avanse, HDFC Credila, Auxilo or InCred, which offer unsecured loans with a co-applicant). Compare **effective rate, processing fee, moratorium interest treatment, prepayment penalty and the tuition/living disbursement split**. * **Pay simple interest during the course** if family cash flow allows. It rises to about ₹30k a month once a ₹30 L loan is fully disbursed, and paying it avoids about **₹3.8 L** of capitalised interest. Even partial payments help. * Loan-financed education remittances from a recognised lender are **exempt from TCS** under current LRS rules. Confirm with the bank at disbursement. Self-funded remittances above ₹10 L attract TCS. * Interest paid on the loan qualifies for the **Section 80E** deduction for up to 8 years if anyone in India (Bhumika or a co-borrowing parent) has taxable income.

5. Post-study employment framework

Stage	Permission	Rule
During study	**Stamp 2**	Up to 20 hrs/week in term; 40 hrs/week 1 June – 30 September and 15 December – 15 January. 2026 minimum wage €14.15/hr.
After results	**Stamp 1G (Third Level Graduate Programme)**	Level 9: up to **24 months** (12 + 12, renewable if conditions are met). Full-time work allowed without an employment permit.
To stay long term	**Critical Skills Employment Permit (CSEP)**	€40,904 minimum for roles on the Critical Skills Occupations List with a relevant degree; **€36,848 for a recent relevant graduate** (within 12 months). Leads to Stamp 4 after 2 years.
Alternative	**General Employment Permit (GEP)**	€36,605 minimum; **€34,009 for a recent qualifying Irish graduate**. Occupation eligibility applies.

Salary bands vs thresholds (Dublin 2026 recruitment guides):

Role	0–3 yrs	3–5 yrs	Clears GEP?
Tax Analyst / Senior (Big 4, in-house)	€45–55k	€50–60k	✅ Comfortably
Risk Analyst	€40–60k	€45–70k	✅
Regulatory / Financial Reporting Analyst	€40–52k	€50–65k	✅
Compliance Analyst	€30–35k (pure entry) → €35–45k	€35–45k	🟡 Target the upper band. Her 3.5 years of prior experience should be pitched as 3–5 years.

Strategic implication: Tax, regulatory reporting and risk analytics clear permit thresholds more reliably than generalist compliance roles. That is why the Galway accounting-analytics route is ranked #1.

6. Scholarship and fee-waiver playbook

Scheme	Value	How	Treatment
GOI-IES (Government of Ireland International Education Scholarship, run by the HEA)	Full tuition waiver + **€10,000 stipend**, 60 awards nationally	Applicant must already **hold a conditional or final offer**. The 2026 call ran 29 Jan – 12 Mar 2026; **expect a similar Jan–Mar 2027 window**.	Apply. Never budget for it.
DCU Business School International Scholarship 2027/28	€2,000 fee reduction	Automatic on DC526/DC537 application	Upside
Galway Cairnes Business PG Merit Scholarships 2027/28	To be announced (under review)	Watch the Cairnes scholarships page from November	Upside
UL International merit awards	Partial fee reduction (historical)	Check UL Global in November 2026	Upside
Application-fee waivers (€35–€55 each)	Fee only	*Education in Ireland* fairs in Bengaluru, university India representatives, official webinars	Nice to have; worth one email each

Fee-waiver email script (to each university's India representative):

> Subject: Fee waiver request — MSc [Programme], September 2027 — Bhumika V S
>
> Dear [Name], I am a Senior Compliance Associate at Amazon (Global Seller Risk & Compliance) with prior experience as a Tax Analyst at EY GDS, and a B.Com (8.43/10) and MBA graduate. I am applying for the MSc [Programme] for September 2027 and would be grateful if an application-fee waiver code is available for Indian applicants. I attended the [Education in Ireland fair / webinar on date]. Kind regards, Bhumika V S · +91 91484 85773

7. Document checklist for every application

1. Passport (valid until at least March 2029)
2. B.Com and MBA **official transcripts (all semesters), provisional/degree certificates**, and a **CGPA-to-percentage conversion certificate** from Bangalore University / VTU if the transcripts show only CGPA
3. B.Com **syllabus extract** proving Financial Accounting, Management Accounting and Business Finance (needed for Galway)
4. IELTS Academic Test Report Form
5. One-page CV (Deliverable 2)

6. Programme-specific SOP (Deliverable 3)
7. Two academic and one professional reference (Deliverable 4). Most Irish portals email referees directly, so brief referees in advance.
8. Experience letters: EY relieving letter, Amazon employment verification
9. Certificates: Great Learning, Milestone Academy, AICE rank certificate

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Sources checked 2–15 October 2026: University of Galway MSc IAA Pathway A programme page & 2026/27 handbook; University of Galway India entry requirements; Cairnes Business PG Merit Scholarships 2027/28 notice; UL Kemmy Business School MSc Insurance & Risk Management course page; UL Studentpad statistics; DCU MSc International Accounting & Business course page and registration schedule; DCU International Scholarships Non-EU 2027/28; Chartered Accountants Ireland DCU exemptions; Trinity Business School MSc OSCM fees 2027/28; Trinity cost of living; HEA GOI-IES; Irish Immigration (student finances, work hours, Third Level Graduate Programme); Dept. of Enterprise employment permit thresholds (1 March 2026); WRC national minimum wage 2026; Morgan McKinley Dublin salary guides 2026. This is a planning document, not a guarantee of admission, scholarship, visa, loan or employment.